II

The constitutional guarantee of free speech "serves significant societal interests" wholly apart from the speaker's interest in self-expression. *First National Bank of Boston* v. *Bellotti*, 435 U. S. 765, 776 (1978). By protecting those who wish to enter the marketplace of ideas from government attack, the First Amendment protects the public's interest in receiving information. See *Thornhill* v. *Alabama*, 310 U. S. 88, 102 (1940); *Saxbe* v. *Washington Post Co.*, 417 U. S. 843, 863–864 (1974) (POWELL, J., dissenting). The identity of the speaker is not decisive in determining whether speech is protected. Corporations and other associations, like individuals, contribute to the "discussion, debate, and the dissemination of information and ideas" that the First Amendment seeks to foster. *First National Bank of Boston* v. *Bellotti*, *supra*, at 783 (citations omitted). Thus, in *Bellotti*, we invalidated a state prohibition aimed at speech by corporations that sought to influence the outcome of a state referendum. 435 U. S., at 795. Similarly, in *Consolidated Edison Co.* v. *Public Service Comm'n of N. Y.*, 447 U. S. 530, 544 (1980), we invalidated a state order prohibiting a privately owned utility company from discussing controversial political issues in its billing envelopes. In both cases, the critical considerations were that the State sought to abridge speech that the First Amendment is designed to protect, and that such prohibitions limited the range of information and ideas to which the public is exposed. *First National Bank of Boston* v. *Bellotti*, *supra*, at 776–778, 781–783; *Consolidated Edison Co.* v. *Public Service Comm'n of N. Y.*, *supra*, at 533–535.

There is no doubt that under these principles appellant's newsletter *Progress* receives the full protection of the First Amendment. *Lovell* v. *Griffin*, 303 U. S. 444, 452 (1938). In appearance no different from a small newspaper, *Progress*' contents range from energy-saving tips to stories about wildlife conservation, and from billing information to recipes. App. to Juris. Statement A–183 to A–190. *Progress* thus